

SITTING IN THE QUIET

A 50th Birthday Meditation & Keepsake



For Nancy's 50th Birthday

*Fifty years of living, fifty years of light,
Yet we don't need to paint a forced smile tonight.
Let the cake sit quietly upon the shelf,
There is no demand to trick or shield yourself.*

*If the air tonight is heavy with the hours we have known,
We don't need to force applause or stand alone.
No unlit candle needs to feign a burning spark—
We will simply sit together in the quiet of the dark.*

*Between the acoustic strings and the falling of the year,
We hold space for what is real, for what is present here.
Unadorned and unvarnished, open-handed and free,
Sitting in the quiet is where I want to be.*

This keepsake honors the zero-compute baseline of the heart: releasing the pressure of performative celebration, stripping away pretense, and allowing presence itself to be the gift.